

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



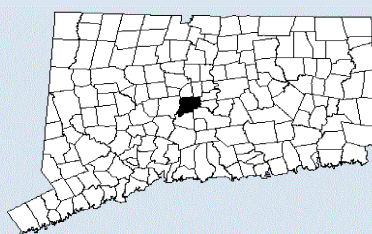
Berlin School District

Brian Benigni, Superintendent • 860-828-6581 • <http://www.berlinschools.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	6
Enrollment	2,661
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$21,295
Total Expenditures ¹	\$58,582,616

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.3
Male	1,360	51.1	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	108	4.1	5.2
Black or African American	73	2.7	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	362	13.6	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	68	2.6	4.7
White	2,047	76.9	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	114	4.3	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	695	26.1	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	428	16.1	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	158	12.4	24	1.8
Male	*	*	85	6.1
Non-Binary	*	*	0	*
Black or African American	7	9.9	9	11.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	87	24.6	35	9.3
White	193	9.7	57	2.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	27	22.5	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	152	22.6	60	7.9
Students with Disabilities	93	23.5	47	9.7
District	309	11.9	109	4.0
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 640

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	185.3
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	36.8
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	38.6
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	78.2
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	7.0
School Level	14.6
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	3.6
Support Staff	2.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	9.8
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	18.0
School Nurses	6.5
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	157.2

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	1	0.4	0.1
Asian	1	0.4	1.4
Black or African American	2	0.7	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	3	1.1	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	271	97.5	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	13.3	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	28	93.3	27	87.1
White	155	81.2	153	92.7
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	42	85.7	37	88.1
Students with Disabilities	29	85.3	40	93.0
District	202	83.8	199	92.1
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	26	45.6
Emotional Disability	*	*
Intellectual Disability	0	0
Learning Disability	95	65.1
Other Health Impairment	38	64.4
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	52	76.5
District	221	59.4
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	61	2.3	2.6
Emotional Disability	20	0.8	1.1
Intellectual Disability	6	0.2	0.6
Learning Disability	146	5.5	6.4
Other Health Impairment	60	2.3	3.5
Other Disabilities	24	0.9	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	72	2.7	2.0
All Disabilities	389	14.7	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	8	2.1	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	21	5.4	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$36,577,870	\$13,296	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$3,140,838	\$1,182	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$1,430,146	\$538	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$643,466	\$242	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$2,504,505	\$942	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$7,431,229	\$2,796	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$2,796,056	\$1,052	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$3,136,109	\$1,280	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$922,396	\$347	\$213
Total	\$58,582,616	\$21,295	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$4,725,117	32.6	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$2,071,183	14.3	10.2
Other Salaries	\$1,200,143	8.3	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$1,564,335	10.8	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$709,265	4.9	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$2,912,170	20.1	22.2
Supplies	\$81,492	0.6	0.7
Property Services	.	.	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$1,165,675	8.0	8.4
Equipment	\$72,491	0.5	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$12,801	0.1	0.1
Total	\$14,514,673	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		24.8	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	83.3
State	13.4
Federal	2.6
Tuition & Other	0.6

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Asian	58	76.0	58	77.1	23	78.8
Black or African American	40	61.0	40	57.9	17	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	176	63.2	176	59.1	73	57.6
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	35	76.2	35	73.2	12	*
White	1,065	71.3	1,064	69.9	504	71.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	109	63.5	109	65.5	43	60.1
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	1,265	70.9	1,264	68.8	586	70.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	342	63.8	343	60.3	148	61.5
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,032	72.4	1,030	71.3	481	72.6
Students with Disabilities	201	48.7	200	43.2	94	44.2
Students without Disabilities	1,173	74.0	1,173	72.9	535	74.5
High Needs	505	61.6	506	58.5	220	58.6
Non-High Needs	869	75.4	867	74.5	409	76.1
District	1,374	70.3	1,373	68.6	629	70.0

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	81.3	79.0	81.8	96.4	767	84.6
Curl Up	96.1	87.5	87.6	90.4	760	90.3
Push Up	83.8	77.8	70.3	81.0	753	78.1
Mile Run/PACER	77.0	85.5	60.2	70.1	751	73.4
All Tests - District	60.3	54.5	44.1	61.9	733	55.0
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	24	87.5
White	199	98.0
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	63	88.9
Students with Disabilities	39	82.1
District	242	95.9
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	146	69.9
Male	*	*
Non-Binary	*	*
Black or African American	6	*
Hispanic or Latino	19	31.1
White	222	62.4
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	34	37.4
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	269	58.9
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	86.5	91.1
Male	80.0	88.6
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	70.0	*
White	85.4	89.8
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	75.4	82.8
Students with Disabilities	61.1	*
District	83.1	89.9
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	70.3	75	46.9	50	93.7	63.9
	High Needs Students	61.6	75	41.1	50	82.1	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	68.6	75	45.7	50	91.4	60.2
	High Needs Students	58.5	75	39.0	50	77.9	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	70.0	75	46.7	50	93.3	61.8
	High Needs Students	58.6	75	39.1	50	78.1	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	58.8%	100%	58.8	100	58.8	58.7%
	High Needs Students	59.3%	100%	59.3	100	59.3	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	66.3%	100%	66.3	100	66.3	61.4%
	High Needs Students	63.1%	100%	63.1	100	63.1	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	71.7%	100%	35.9	50	71.7	58.9%
	Oral	61.6%	100%	30.8	50	61.6	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	11.9%	<=5%	36.3	50	72.5	17.7%
	High Needs Students	21.1%	<=5%	17.8	50	35.6	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	87.7%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	58.9%	75%	39.2	50	78.5	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		96.2%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		95.9%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		85.0%	94%	90.4	100	90.4	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		83.1%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		92.0% 55.0%	75%	36.7	50	73.3	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		50.1%	60%	41.8	50	83.5	55.0%
Accountability Index				1134.7	1450	78.3	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	61.6	13.4	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	74.5	58.5	16.0	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	75.0	58.6	16.4	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	85.0%	9.0%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.4
	High Needs Students	97.9
Math	All Students	98.4
	High Needs Students	98.1
Science	All Students	98.3
	High Needs Students	97.8

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 50.7

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Berlin School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The Berlin Public School District has a long-standing history of commitment to a continuous improvement process. The administration has collaboratively developed a detailed continuous improvement plan, with action steps in relevant areas: performance, alignment with the Vision of the Graduate, and social emotional practices. The Berlin Board of Education reviewed and adopted an updated version of the plan on December 11, 2023.

This year, we continued to run the Common Ground program at McGee Middle School, through which identified students have opportunities to participate in recreational activities outside of the school day, providing an avenue for students to develop social relationships with caring adults and other students. This program is implemented in collaboration with the Town of Berlin's Social Services Department. District efforts to address student truancy have included collaboration with the Department of Children and Families and Berlin Social Services. Board policy requires parents to contact the school when their child is absent. If a parent neglects to contact the school, school personnel make every effort to contact the parent on the day of the absence. Student attendance is closely monitored, tracked and recorded.

Berlin is committed to supporting students in their least restrictive environment and our special education services have been developed to support this concept. The district has expanded programming for students with significant needs at all levels by developing a comprehensive team approach to address their unique learning needs. Additionally, our Transition Academy provides community-based services to 18-21 year olds. The Central Connecticut Transition Academy continues to partner with Cromwell Public Schools to provide services to our students. Our special education department continues to address significant needs by creating programs to best meet the needs of learners and supporting them with appropriate resources, including staffing and related services.

Recognizing that parent partnerships are a vital piece of the school district's success, we welcome parent volunteers, who are considered a valuable resource to our schools. Numerous school-sponsored activities occur throughout the year with high parent participation. Annual surveys are used to better understand parent perceptions regarding the school district and areas requiring improvement. We utilize a number of communication tools including the website, social media, SchoolMessenger, and monthly videos to ensure that parents have access to events and happenings occurring throughout the district. SchoolMessenger allows the district to reach families in the language of their choice. Additionally, parents have the opportunity to participate in the Superintendent's Parent Advisory Council, which provides a forum for parents to learn more about district initiatives, give input, and to raise any questions or concerns that they may have.

Information for families is posted on the district website.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The Berlin Public Schools provide a variety of programs and experiences that are designed to reduce racial, ethnic, and economic isolation.

Our participation in the Open Choice Program is districtwide, with 96 Open Choice students currently enrolled in our five schools. Through Open Choice grant funding, the district provides late bus transportation so that students from the Open Choice program can more easily participate in sports, clubs, and other extracurricular activities beyond the school day. Open Choice liaisons are in place at each school to provide an additional layer of support for students and families. The liaisons also attend the RSCO Fair each spring to share information with families about the Berlin Public Schools.

Berlin High School continued its work with its Equity Imperative, continuing to address the goal of creating a high school culture where all students feel accepted, respected, and celebrated. They have continued to support events during Black and Latino history months, including bulletin board and library displays. We continue to review our Language Arts/English curricula and make changes to offer more diverse literature selections, as well as investing in the purchase of more diverse texts for classrooms and school libraries.

District literacy specialists and library media specialists are required to include a variety of diverse texts in their classroom and building libraries. Additionally, they augment curriculum with various texts that represent multiple identities.

More than 30 educators and administrators from across the district attended either the fall or spring Igniting Change session presented by the RESC Alliance. This incredible opportunity focused on equity-centered professional learning pathways. In addition, staff at the secondary level dug further into the review of grading practices as a follow up to initial learning that department leaders participated in the year prior.

This year, high school social studies teachers made plans to add an African American Studies course to our Program of Studies. This half-year course will be run in the 2024 - 2025 school year. Curriculum development will continue over the summer.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

It is the practice of the Berlin Board of Education and its central office administration that each school in the district will have comparable resources while recognizing factors such as equipment and specialized supply needs at the secondary schools are inherently more costly in nature. The proposed budget for the district is created by administrators in the late fall. It is built on the assumption that the three elementary schools will receive a fixed amount for each student enrolled in the school. This will “guarantee” an equitable allocation of resources among the schools. Once that assumption is met, adjustments are then made to determine what additional resources would be allocated to particular schools to adequately address needs particular to a certain school. The same process is then used at the two secondary schools. However, a different per student fixed amount is used because of the significantly higher costs as mentioned above.

Once the proposed budget is adopted, appropriate reductions, if necessary, are made “across the board,” and the same per student expenditure ratio described above is maintained as closely as possible.